

Meris McElveen

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EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Major: Bachelor of Science, Information Science, Bachelor of Arts, Biology

Expected Graduation: Dec 2025

Minor: Data Science

Honors/Awards: Dean's List Fall 2023, Dean's List Spring 2024, Selected speaker at 2024 NC-LSAMP research conference

Relevant Coursework: Foundations of Statistics and Data Science, Introduction to Programming and Data Science, Personalized Genomics, Tools for Information Literacy, Introduction to Database Concepts & Applications

EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Undergraduate researcher, UNC Biology Department

May 2024 – Present

- Conducted research with the Rob Downen Lab, building on prior summer work exploring gut metabolism in *C. elegans*.
- Investigated deep genetic interactions between previously identified *acs* gene family members and *fat-5*.
- Developed reporter strains containing identified mutant-*acs* gene family members, for use in future experiments.
- Developed wet lab skills including genetic crossing, primer design, PCR, gel electrophoresis, RNAi, microscopy.
- Completed a 10-page research paper, highlighting critical insights into gene interaction and metabolic modulation found over the semester.
- Acquired effective scientific communication, research, analytical skills.

Hospital Volunteer

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Administrative volunteer, UNC Hospital

August 2024 – Present

- Supported nursing staff by leading organization of essential informational resources and unit supplies.
- Assembled educational informational packets for various types of diabetic patients.
- Implemented a dedicated supply closet to hold all educational materials and unit supplies, allowing for easy access and efficient inventory management for staff.

SMART Program

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Participant, UNC Biology Department

May 2024 – July 2024

- Independent research with the Rob Downen Lab in the Biology department investigating gut metabolism in *C. elegans*.
- Investigated genetic interactions between key lipid metabolic genes involved in the gut-metabolic host response.
- Successfully identified five *acs* gene family members with significant roles in modulation of *fat-5*.
- Developed wet lab skills including genetic crossing, primer design, PCR, gel electrophoresis, RNAi, microscopy.
- Designed and presented a poster on key findings at the UNC OGE Summer Research Symposium, highlighting direction in future research.
- Participated in workshops focused on developing effective scientific communication and research skills.

CURE Lab (Course -Based Undergraduate Research)

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Lab Member, UNC Biology Department

August 2023 – December 2023

- Collaborative research project with the Reed Lab in the Biology department focusing on gene editing and cloning using CRISPR/CAS9 technologies.
- Deepening understanding of the full process of gene editing.
- Developed wet lab skills including gRNA design, preparing buffer/stock solution, mini-prep protocol, and oligonucleotide annealing.
- Developed proficiency in DNA purification and gene identification using SnapGene technology.
- Contributed thoughtful feedback for future course development and improvement.

TranscribeNC

Raleigh, North Carolina

Volunteer Transcriber, State Archives of North Carolina

June 2021 – Present

- Accurately transcribed handwritten documents, including diaries, letters, and journals, and digitized over 100 documents for easy accesses and preservation.
- Collaborated with other volunteers of the archival team to organize and categorize transcribed documents.
- Developed a higher knowledge of archival practices and procedures.
- Developed high organizational and time-management skills.

Laboratory Researcher

Huntersville, North Carolina

Independent Researcher, International Baccalaureate Diploma Program

May 2021 – January 2022

- Conducted independent microbiology research, investigating the interactions between alcohol and *E. Coli* and Staph. Epidermis.
- Completed a 4,000-word research paper, under submission to the International Baccalaureate Program for grade review.

- Developed proficiency in bacterial culturing, isolation, and classification of microorganisms, and research methodologies.

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

SEO Career

New York, NY

SEO EDGE Participant

January 2024 – Present

- Receive coaching and online instruction to achieve targeted interview, technical, and professional developmental goals
- Learn business fundamentals to compete successfully for internship opportunities
- Complete industry-specific training focused on developing technical skills, institutional knowledge, and attention to detail

Undergraduate Learning Assistant

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

Peer Mentor, UNC Biology Department

January 2024 – Present

- Assisted in an introductory biology laboratory course of over 100 students over two academic semesters.
- Mentored over 20 students in appropriate laboratory skills and practices.

OTHER SKILLS & INTERESTS

Computer: Microsoft Applications (Excel, Word, PowerPoint & Outlook), Google Applications, HTML/CSS, Python, Matlab, SQL

Interests: Genomic research, Health Informatics, UX/UI Design